

TONY BAKER

AI & Business Adviser

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AI and business adviser with 26+ years of experience spanning executive leadership, commercial software, product modernisation and applied AI. Helps leadership teams identify worthwhile AI opportunities across products, operations and day-to-day business workflows, turn them into practical delivery plans and build the capability needed for sustained adoption. Combines hands-on knowledge of AI and agentic systems with experience establishing and leading an Asia-Pacific business, building multidisciplinary teams and working directly with customers across international markets. Brings independent technical judgement, commercial awareness and a pragmatic approach to value, delivery risk, data, operating constraints and organisational change.

ADVISORY FOCUS

AI opportunity assessment and prioritisation | Adoption strategy and leadership enablement | Product and operational use cases | Technical due diligence | Platform modernisation | Delivery, data and integration risk | Evidence-led investment decisions

SELECTED BUSINESS & AI IMPACT

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- Established TESLA Forecasting's Asia-Pacific presence and built it into a 10-person multidisciplinary operation spanning business development, sales, support, engineering, forecasting analysis and operations.
 - Led practical AI adoption across forecasting engineering teams in APAC and the United States, achieving 100% AI-assisted development adoption through workshops, coaching, examples and guardrails.
 - Designed forecasting automation that reduced complex model setup from several hours of multi-team work to approximately 10 minutes of analyst self-service.
 - Built a grounded RAG chatbot proof of concept by converting approximately 20,000 energy news articles into vector-searchable content, with query rewriting and quality and safety controls.
 - Reduced weather ensemble forecasting solve time from approximately 25 minutes to under one minute, while replacing thousands of lines of configuration with a small automatically generated file.
 - Delivered performance improvements of 80-99% in selected workflows and reduced database CPU demand by approximately 10-15% on a large production system.

LEADERSHIP & PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Distinguished Engineer | Yes Energy | May 2024 - 2022

Senior hands-on adviser and technical leader focused on AI adoption, platform modernisation, automation, architecture and engineering effectiveness. Worked across engineering, forecasting, operations and product concerns while building production services, proof-of-concepts and practical adoption patterns.

Managing Director | TESLA Asia Pacific | March 2021 - May 2024

Led Asia-Pacific operations across engineering, forecasting analysis, support, sales, business development and customer delivery. Built and developed a 10-person multidisciplinary team, maintained senior customer and partner relationships and supported integration into Yes Energy following acquisition.

Regional Director | TESLA Asia Pacific | December 2010 - March 2021

Established and grew the Asia-Pacific presence from the ground up. Combined regional leadership, customer relationships, business development, product support and hands-on software delivery while collaborating with teams in the United States, United Kingdom and Asia-Pacific.

Technical Manager | TESLA Europe Limited | July 2002 - November 2010

Led and contributed to commercial electricity and gas forecasting software for major energy-market participants. Translated complex customer and analyst requirements into reliable product capability and operational processes.

Earlier Career | New Zealand and United Kingdom | 1997 - 2002

Software engineering and deployment roles with Trimble Navigation, FFastFill, Barclays Bank, HSBC AssetFinance and MAF Quality Management.

EDUCATION & INTERNATIONAL EXPERIENCE

- Bachelor of Computing and Mathematical Sciences (First Class Honours), Software Engineering - University of Waikato, New Zealand
- Best Presentation Award in Computing and Mathematical Sciences - University of Waikato, 1998
- 23+ years working across New Zealand, United Kingdom, United States and Asia-Pacific teams and time zones

TECHNOLOGY CONTEXT

Applied AI and agents, RAG, vector search, Microsoft Foundry / Azure AI Foundry, OpenAI and Azure AI; software architecture, distributed and event-driven systems, SaaS and critical infrastructure; C#, .NET, TypeScript, React, SQL, Azure, AWS, Kubernetes and CI/CD.